



EXPLORING THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN REGULAR EXERCISE ON MENTAL HEALTH AND ACADEMIC PERFORMANCE OF APU STUDENTS

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ABSTRACT

Many university students face ongoing academic demands that can strain their mental health and overall performance. Understanding practical ways to manage this pressure is important, and physical activity is often suggested as a possible support. This study examines how regular exercise may influence stress levels, emotional balance, and academic outcomes among students at Asia Pacific University (APU).. A one time online survey using a 5 point Likert scale was completed by 36 students to measure exercise frequency and its perceived effects on stress, mood, focus, and academic performance. Over 80 percent of respondents reported exercising at least three times a week, and 92 percent agreed that physical activity helps them release tension and clear their mind. Seventy eight percent felt they performed better academically when active, linking exercise with stronger concentration and motivation. These results suggest that regular physical activity supports mental balance and study performance. Future research should involve a larger sample to strengthen the reliability of these findings.

INTRODUCTION

University life often comes with heavy workloads, fast-paced routines, and constant pressure to perform, which can take a toll on students’ mental well-being. Because of this, many students look for simple habits that might help them manage stress and stay focused. One of the most common suggestions is regular exercise, but its actual impact on students’ mental health and academic performance isn’t always clear. This study explores whether exercising regularly truly helps APU students feel better emotionally and perform better academically. By understanding this relationship, we hope to highlight how small lifestyle choices like staying active a few times a week might make a meaningful difference in students’ daily lives.

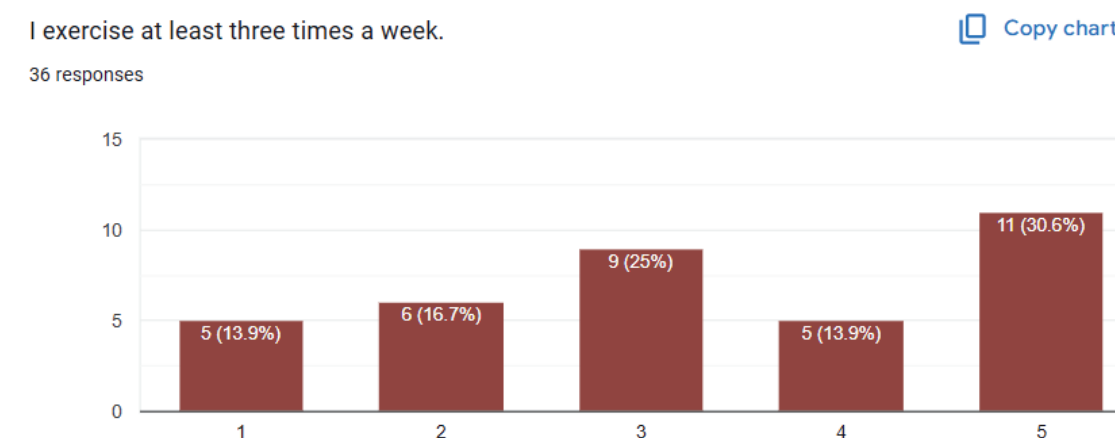
SIGNIFICANCE OF STUDY

- Provide the insight on how regular exercise can help students' mental health.
- Help identify how regular exercise can reduce students’ academic stress.
- Provide comparative data across different student demographics on how exercise affects their mental health and academic performance.

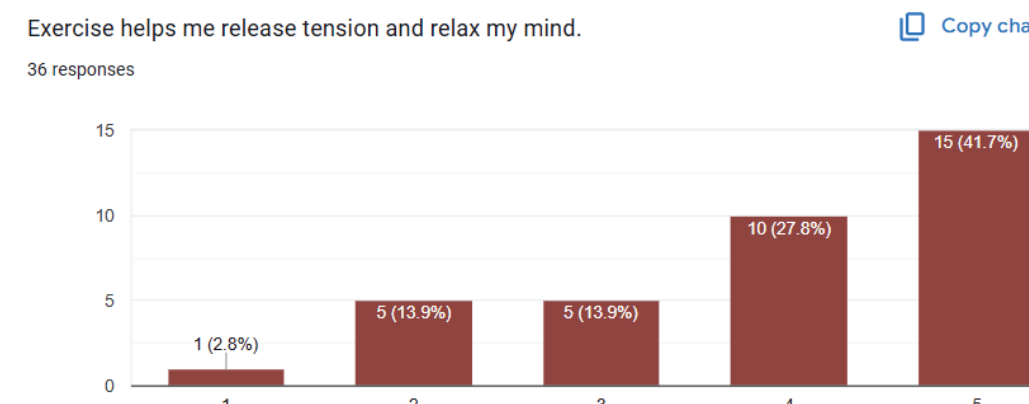
METHODOLOGY

- Research Design: Utilized a one-time survey incorporating a 5-point likert rating scale.
- Participants: Involved a sample size of 36 APU students.
- Primary Aim: To analyze how regular exercise correlates with mental health and academic performance.
- Secondary Aim: To investigate whether exercise serves as a buffer to reduce the impact of academic stress.

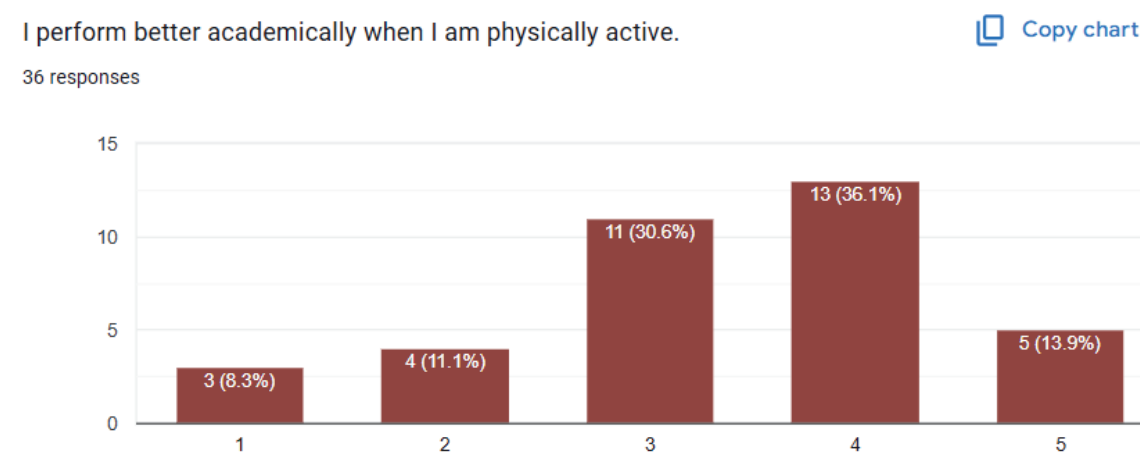
FINDINGS



Based on the survey responses from 36 APU students, the results show a positive relationship between regular exercise, mental health, and academic performance. The average response for “I exercise at least three times a week” was 3.31%, suggesting that most students exercise moderately often, though not all maintain a consistent routine.



For mental well-being, the statement “Exercise helps me release tension and relax my mind” received a higher mean score of 3.92%, indicating that most respondents strongly believe physical activity helps reduce stress and improve their mood.



In terms of academic outcomes, the statement “I perform better academically when I am physically active” had an average score of 3.36%, showing that many students recognize a connection between exercise and better focus, motivation, and academic performance.

Overall, these findings suggest that while not all APU students exercise regularly, those who do tend to experience better mental relaxation and slightly improved academic performance, supporting the hypothesis that regular physical activity benefits both mental health and learning outcomes.

DISCUSSION

The findings show that regular exercise is strongly linked to better mental well being and stronger academic performance among APU students. Students who stay active report lower stress, a clearer mind, and greater emotional balance. They also believe that physical activity improves their concentration, motivation, and ability to manage coursework. These results indicate that regular exercise plays a meaningful role in supporting both mental health and academic success.

RECOMMENDATION

- Encourage regular exercise among students by organizing health programs.
- Improve access to gym facilities to make exercise convenient.
- Conduct campaigns showing the mental health and academic benefits of exercise.
- Support students with wellness initiatives to boost overall well-being.
- Promote student-led fitness communities to focus engagement and motivation.

CONCLUSION

This study show that physical activity can reduce stress, improve mood, and enhance academic concentration among the APU students. It does possess certain limitations such as the small sample size and individuals just reporting their own data. A larger and more varied sample should be used in future studies. In general, the results indicate the remarkable effect that consistent and regular physical exercise could have on the well-being of the students and their academic performance.

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